Lesson 28 material: Pronunciation: Reduced Words

English Stage 1 (B1) · Unit 3: Zero Waste

3.5: Reduced Words

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Original page, with audio and online exercises:
https://human.libretexts.org/Bookshelves/Languages/English_as_a_Second_Language/Book%3A_Speaking_Listening_and_Pronunciation_Projects_for_ELLs_-_Intermediate_Level_(Zemlick)/03%3A_Zero_Waste/3.05%3A_Reduced_Words
Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

Audio for this section is saved on your computer in `E:\personal-tutor\materials\library\esl-b1-speaking\attachments\03.05-reduced-words`: Listening Practice - Drop the H; Listening Practice - Reduced Function Words; Listening Practice 1 Can vs Can't; Listening Practice 2 Can vs Can't; Reduced Words Examples; Review Reduced Words; Summary - Andy's job

Watch the Video

Elemental English: De-Stressed Function Words

Video: https://youtu.be/R0_v3DwdbRA

Commonly Reduced Function Words

Listen to each of the function words and the example sentences in the table below. Practice saying the sentences with a partner. (Audio on the lesson web page: "Reduced Words Examples")

Word	What it sounds like	Example Sentence
to	/tə/	You should talk to Charlie.
for	/fər/	I had eggs for breakfast.
at	/ət/	I'll see you at school.
and	/ən/ /ɪn/ /n/	I'll have the soup and sandwich, please.
or	/ər/	Tea or coffee?
you	/yə/	Do you like it?
him/her	/əm/ /ər/	I called him last night. / I called her last night.
have	/əv/ /ə/	Where have you been?
can	/kən/	I can sing. Can you?
do	/də/	What do you want?
as	/əz/	Light as a feather, stiff as a board.
of	/ev/ /ə/*	I'd like a cup of tea, please. / He gave me a box of apples.

*Note: /əv/ is often used before a word that starts with a vowel sound (example: All /əv/ our friends were there. /ə/ is often used before a consonant sound: (Example: There were a lot /ə/ people.)

Listening Practice: Reduced Function Words

Read the sentences below. One of the function words is missing in each sentence. Listen to the recording, and write the missing function word. (Audio on the lesson web page: "Listening Practice - Reduced Function Words")

EXERCISE

Listen to the recording and fill in the missing function words.

1. . . . today I'm going _____ show you how _____ make zero waste toothpaste.
2. I've been using it _____ years . . .
3. I grew up in Oxford which is _____ small city in England . . .
4. Where _____ you living now?
5. I have a younger brother _____ an older sister . . .
6. Would you like coffee _____ tea?
7. You can't come to Berlin _____ not eat a Currywurst!

8. The Berlin wall stands _____ a memorial to freedom.

9. The park . . . was full _____ wild deer and other animals.

10. Do you _____ a car?

Listening: Function Words and Andy's Job

Listen to the recording from Unit 2. Complete the paragraph about Andy with the missing function words. Notice how the function words are reduced. They might be a little difficult to hear. (Audio on the lesson web page: "Summary - Andy's job")

EXERCISE

Listen to the recording and fill in the missing function words.

Andy is from Oxford, but (1) _____ lives in San Diego. In (2)_____ free time, Andy likes to read (3)_____ go running. He also cooks, plays the guitar, and listens (4)_____ podcasts. He avoids eating meat because meat production hurts the environment. Andy is (5) _____ farmer. He drives (6) _____ pickup truck. Everyday he works outside. He plants (7) _____ waters crops. He also pulls weeds and does harvesting, and (8) _____ repairs fences. He loves working outside (9) _____ taking lots (10) _____ fresh air. Andy teaches other famers about sustainable agriculture. He wants (11) _____ teach them how (12) _____ protect the environment.

When you're finished, look at the transcript from your Unit 2 recording to check your answers.

Drop the "h"

Watch the Video: Elemental English - "h" deletion with connected speech

Video: https://youtu.be/55vpaD2p4xI

Rules to Remember

Rules to Remember: Drop the H

When structure words such as her, he, him, his, have, has or had occur in the middle of a phrase, the h sound is often dropped.

Examples:

- What did he do? . . . *sounds like* . . . What didee do?
- Will he call me? . . .*sounds like* . . . Willy call me?

Note: You do not need to drop the "h" for others to understand you. However, many native speakers often drop the "h" so understanding that the "h" is often dropped will help you with your listening skills.

Practice

1. Cross out the "h" and draw a line linking the vowel sound of the h word with the previous word. Then rewrite the sentence the way it sounds.
2. Practice reading the sentences. Remember to drop the "h" and link the vowel sound to the previous word. When you're ready, record yourself reading each of the sentences.

Example: Send her an application. = Sender an application.

1. Say goodbye before he leaves. = _____
2. What did he get her for her birthday? = _____
3. She has a lot to do today. = _____
4. Take him out for a walk before dinner. = _____
5. You'll have a lot of friends there. =_____
6. He danced his heart out tonight. = _____

Watch the Video: How to link words that begin with H - Rachel's English

Video: https://youtu.be/QuOw_KnFk3Y

Listening Practice: Drop the "h"

Listen to the speaker read each of the sentences. Complete each sentence with the missing words. There are two words missing from each sentence. (Audio on the lesson web page: "Listening Practice - Drop the H")

EXERCISE

Fill in the missing words

1. I'll _____ we're leaving.

2. Don't _____ a watch on?

3. _____ get lost?

4. She _____ car into a tree.

5. What _____ name again?

6. I _____ no.

7. Jan _____ book all afternoon.

8. He _____ bus because he slept too late.

9. _____ there?

10. _____ you done?

Can vs Can't

Watch the Video: Elemental English - Can vs. Can't

Video: https://youtu.be/T-XZHX7DpdU

Rules to Remember: Can vs Can't

Rules to Remember: Can vs Can't

What's the difference between the pronunciation of "can" and "can't? Listen to the sentences below.

- Lauren can make toothpaste. I can't make toothpaste.
- Andy can grow vegetables. I can't grow vegetables.

The word "can" is usually reduced. That means you say it with a schwa /ə/ (/kən/). The word "c *an't"* is usually said with a clear /æ/ sound like in "apple" or "answer".

Listening Practice 1: Can vs Can't

Listen to the person talking about videos you've seen this semester. Is she saying "can" or "can't"? Underline the word you hear. (Audio on the lesson web page: "Listening Practice 1 Can vs Can't")

Example: Lauren (<u>can</u>/can't) make toothpaste.

1. In Berlin, you (can/can't) try curry wurst. It's delicious!
2. You (can/can't) come to Berlin, and not try a curry wurst.
3. You (can/can't) use peppermint or cinnamon flavor in your toothpaste recipe.
4. You (can/can't) use whatever you want to stir the toothpaste.
5. (Can/Can't) you reduce the amount of trash you make?
6. Andy loves to grow vegetables. He (can/can't) grow any vegetables you want.

Compare your answers with a partner and then check them with the class.

Listening Practice 2: Can vs Can't

Listen to more sentences. Do you hear "can" or "can't"? Underline the word you hear. (Audio on the lesson web page: "Listening Practice 2 Can vs Can't")

1. We (can/can't) help them, but we (can/can't) do it for them.
2. We (can/can't) eat food in the classroom.
3. Students (can/can't) turn in assignments early, but they (can/can't) turn them in late.
4. (Can/ Can't) you show it to me?
5. I (can/can't) do it.
6. I (can/can't) understand.
7. Question: (Can/Can't) you help later? Answer: I (can/can't).
8. Question: (Can/Can't) you come to the party? Answer: I (can/can't).
9. She (can/can't) see him.
10. He (can/can't) see her.
11. I don't know where you came from, but you (can/can't) stay here.
12. We (can/can't) go.
13. I (can/can't) be there by twelve.

14. I (can/can't) make it on Saturday, but I (can/can't) go on Sunday.
15. He (can/can't) understand what I'm saying.
16. She (can/can't) wear a size small.
17. You (can/can't) have all the dessert you want.
18. They (can/can't) do it.

AnswerS - Can vs Can't.docx

Speaking Practice: Can vs Can't

Find someone who can or can't do the following things. Walk around and ask your classmates: "Can you . . .?" Write their names on teh lines below and underline "can" or "can't."

Example:

- Q: Can you play the guitar?
- A: Yes, I can.

_____Andy_____ (can/can't) play the guitar.

Interview your classmates

1. _____ (can/can't) play the guitar.
2. _____ (can/can't) cook.
3. _____ (can/can't) ride a horse.
4. _____ (can/can't) tap dance.
5. _____ (can/can't) sing.
6. _____ (can/can't) fly an airplane.
7. _____ (can/can't) eat spicy food.
8. _____ (can/can't) swim.
9. _____ (can/can't) run fast.
10. _____ (can/can't) sew.

Share what you learned

What did you learn about your classmates? Share you answers with the class?

Example:

I learned that Andy can play the guitar, but Brittany can't sew.

Review: Reduced Words

Listen to the recording. Complete the sentences with the missing words. (Audio on the lesson web page: "Review Reduced Words")

1. It's super quick _____ easy _____ make.
2. Combine two tablespoons _____ coconut oil, one tablespoon _____ baking soda, _____ fifteen to twenty drops _____ essential oil.
3. I like _____ use peppermint, _____ you _____ use cinnamon _____ spearmint.
4. I like to use _____ compostable toothbrush _____ a spoon.
5. If it's too hard, put _____ under some warm water _____ _____ few minutes.

Recording: Reduced Words

1. Read the sentences below. Underline the function words.
2. Listen to these sentences. Then practice reading the sentences out loud.
3. When you're ready, record yourself reading each sentence. Remember to stress the content words and reduce the function words.

Transcript

1. It's **sup**er **quick** and **eas**y to **make.**
2. Com**bine two ta**blespoons of **co**conut **o**il, **one ta**blespoon of **bak**ing **so**da, and fif**teen** to **twe**nty **drops** of es**sen**tial **o**il.
3. **I like** to use **pe**ppermint, but **you** can **use cin**namon or s**pear**mint.
4. **I like** to use a com**pos**table **tooth**brush and a **spoon**.
5. If it's **too hard**, put it **un**der some **warm wa**ter for a **few min**utes.